

THE CHERNOBYL DISASTER

Spy satellites will inspect damage at nuclear plant

US presses Russians for quick report from Kiev

From Michael White in Washington

The Reagan Administration has pressed the Soviet Union to provide a full and frank report on the damage to the Chernobyl nuclear power station, which was destroyed by a massive explosion on April 26. US intelligence was told that the Soviet Union was withholding information about the extent of the damage and the number of people who had been evacuated from the area around the plant.

The official US request for information "in a form that would not be used to embarrass the Soviet Union" was made on April 27, according to a State Department spokesman.

The spokesman said that the US was "convinced that the Soviet Union has the capability to provide a full and frank report on the damage to the Chernobyl nuclear power station, and that it is in the best interests of the Soviet Union to do so."

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Bonn critical but ready to give help

From Anna Tugend in Bonn

West Germany yesterday offered Moscow all possible aid and assistance in dealing with the disaster, but experts said there was little practical experience in extinguishing a fire in a graphite-burning reactor.

The new Soviet ambassador to Bonn, Mr. Yuriy Kravtsov, yesterday declared the accident to be the "most serious nuclear disaster in the history of the world."

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The Minister for Research and Technology, Helmut Hees, called on the Soviet Union to agree to international inspection of its nuclear power stations. "This is evidently the worst nuclear accident ever and it still seems to be out of control," a spokesman said.

The Government yesterday placed all radiation monitoring stations on special alert, but said that no dangerous levels had been recorded in the northern states of Schleswig-Holstein and Mecklenburg-Vorpommern.

Finns face problem over Soviet-designed reactors

By Roger Highfield

The Russian nuclear accident has placed Finland in an awkward position, not only because of the failure of the Soviet Union to provide a full and frank report on the damage to the Chernobyl nuclear power station, but also because of the fact that Finland has a number of Soviet-designed reactors in operation.

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Warsaw Pact ponders lessons of tragedy

By Michael Simons

The implications of the nuclear disaster in the Soviet Union for the Warsaw Pact allies are serious and far-reaching.

Not only have extraordinary levels of radiation been recorded at more than 200 monitoring stations in the Soviet Union, but also in the Baltic states of Lithuania, Latvia and Estonia, which are all members of the Warsaw Pact.

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"Here, want a taste?"

Sweden is asked for advice on fighting fire in reactor

From Roland Sandberg in Stockholm

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Atom authority not yet asked for assistance

From Michael Givney

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been given just the weapon it needed to destroy the Soviet Union from the inside.

Until this disaster the Soviet Union had been a major power in the world, and it was not until this disaster that it was seen as a weak power.

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"Here, want a taste?"

Britons 'not in danger' version of events

By Peter Hargrave

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NEWS IN BRIEF

27 die in Tamil rivalry

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Before the disaster: part of the Chernobyl power station